Merits:



- This method ensures accuracy because of personal interaction with the investigator.
- This method enables the interviewer to suitably adjust the situations with the respondent.

Limitations:

- When the field of enquiry is vast,this method is more expensive, time consuming and cumbersome.
- In this type of survey, there is chance for personal bias by the investigator in terms of asking 'leading questions'.

(b) Telephone Interviewing

In the present age of communication explosion, telephones and mobile phones are extensively used to collect data from the respondents. This saves the cost and time of collecting the data with a good amount of accuracy.

(c) Computer Assisted Telephone Interviewing (CATI)

With the widespread use of computers, telephone interviewing can be combined with immediate entry of the response into a data file by means of terminals, personal computers, or voice data entry. Computer – Assisted Telephone Interviewing (CATI) is used in market research organizations throughout the world.

(d) Computer Administered Telephone Survey

Another means of securing immediate response is the computer-administered telephone survey. Unlike CATI, there is no interviewer. A computer calls the phone number, conducts the interview, places data into a file for later tabulation, and terminates the contact. The questions are voice synthesized and the respondent's answer and computer timing trigger continuation or disconnect. The last three methods save time and cost, apart from minimizing the personal bias.

2.2.2 Indirect Method:

The indirect method is used in cases where it is delicate or difficult to get the information from the respondents due to unwillingness or indifference. The information about the respondent is collected by interviewing the third party who knows the respondent well.

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